

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Western Deccan: terrain becomes a fort network

INPUT -> Sahyadri passes + Maval infantry + Konkan creeks + agrarian bases

SERVICE -> Ahmadnagar/Bijapur/Mughal competition opens political space

SHAHJI -> mobile service and Poona base; not a continuous national programme

FORT SYSTEM -> store + refuge + pass + garrison + treasury + bargaining

REQUIRE -> revenue + water + repair + intelligence + local cooperation

VERDICT -> organisation converts terrain into power; geography alone cannot.

MUST REMEMBER: Shivaji's coronation (1674), fort network, revenue claims and military mobility
formed a negotiated regional polity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Chronology from the 1640s to 1707

1640s forts -> 1656 Javli -> 1659 Afzal Khan -> 1663 Shaista Khan
1664 Surat -> 1665 Purandar -> 1666 Agra -> 1670 recovery
1674 coronation -> 1676-79 Karnataka/revenue -> 1680 death
1681 Aurangzeb south -> 1686 Bijapur -> 1687 Golconda
1689 Sambhaji -> Rajaram/Gingee -> 1700 Tarabai
1700-05 siege cycle -> 1707 unresolved imperial exit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Purandar, Agra and recovery

JAI SINGH -> siege + diplomacy + proposed Mughal-Shivaji Deccan partnership

1665 -> 23 forts surrendered | 12 retained | Sambhaji mansab 5000

FORM -> subordinate alliance, not erased sovereignty or final peace

1666 AGRA -> rank/placement/detention produce honour and trust rupture

ESCAPE -> conflict resumes | 1670 -> forts and Surat recovered/raided

MISSED SETTLEMENT -> possible political choice, never guaranteed outcome.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Coronation and the language of sovereignty

1674 RAIGAD -> independent royal rite and public status

GAGA BHATTA -> Kshatriya validation amid contested social rank

PURPOSE -> rise above Maratha chiefs + treaty equality + dynastic legitimacy

IDIOM -> Sanskrit/Hindu kingship and regional political identity

BORROWING -> Deccani-Persianate institutions and mixed service continue

TRAP -> sovereignty claim is not modern communal nationalism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Ashtapradhan: eight offices, not a cabinet

PESHW/AMATYA/SACHIV/MANTRI -> administration, accounts, records, intelligence
SUMANT/SENAPATI/NYAYADHISH/PANDITRAO -> diplomacy, army, justice, grants
RELATION -> each responsible to Shivaji; no collective cabinet sovereignty
LOCAL -> patil/deshmukh/mirasdar/village structures remain negotiated
REFORM -> curb illegal exaction and over-mighty chiefs, not abolish all rights
SOURCE LIMIT -> formal office list does not prove uniform daily functioning.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Chauth and sardeshmukhi are distinct claims

ASSESSMENT -> measurement/classification + village officers + Annaji 1679

INCIDENCE -> about two-fifths plus cesses is debated; do not universalise

CHAUTH -> one-fourth protection/non-raiding and later political claim

SARDESHMUKHI -> separate additional 10% superior-deshmukh claim

LATE WAR -> kamaishdars turn chauth into parallel district collection

TRAP -> fiscal claim does not automatically equal territorial sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Cavalry and ganimi kava

FORCE -> Mavali infantry + light cavalry + forts + intelligence

METHOD -> speed + dispersal + night attack + supply disruption + negotiation

GANIMI KAVA -> adaptive enemy-style irregular war, not timeless doctrine

ALSO -> sieges, defence and set battles remain part of war

MUGHAL BURDEN -> long routes + garrisons + seasons + elusive opponents

VERDICT -> mobility worked as a system with forts and local revenue.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Coast and navy: capability with scale limits

PEOPLE -> Koli + Bhandari + Muslim + Maratha seafaring personnel

CRAFT -> grabs/gallivats/gunboats + trading and supply vessels

FORTS -> Sindhudurg/Vijaydurg/coastal nodes support creeks and routes

AIMS -> Sidi check + trade/protection + supply + intelligence

EUROPEANS -> negotiate/contest Portuguese and English presence

LIMIT -> regional littoral capability, never Indian Ocean blue-water command.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Resistance after Shivaji

1680 -> Sambhaji wins succession | 1681 -> Prince Akbar connection
1689 -> capture/execution removes recognised head, not resistance
RAJARAM -> escapes to Gingee; distant royal centre + dispersed commanders
1698 -> Gingee falls after Rajaram escapes
1700 -> Tarabai leads for Shivaji II
EFFECT -> decentralisation increases resilience and commander autonomy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Annexation removes buffers

1686 BIJAPUR + 1687 GOLCONDA -> direct Mughal annexation

GAIN -> territory, forts, treasury claims and formal sovereignty

LOSS -> buffers, negotiable courts and local responsibility

ADD -> Deccani nobles/soldiers + garrisons + long routes + administration

LOOP 1700-05 -> capture fort -> garrison -> move -> Maratha return

VERDICT -> conquest expands commitments faster than durable pacification.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ashtapradhan was not a modern cabinet; chauth and sardeshmukhi varied by claim, agreement, collection and territory.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Jagirdari terms and the feedback loop

BE-JAGIRI -> delay/shortage of productive assignment | PAIBAQI -> unsettled pool
JAMA/HASIL -> paper claim exceeds collection in war-torn districts
CHAUTH -> parallel Maratha claim | PRIVATE PACT -> jagirdar protects collection
EXPANDED ELITE -> Mughal + Deccani + Maratha claimants
FEEDBACK -> bad jagir -> weak troops/harsh collection -> resistance -> lower hasil
DEBATE -> fiscal + administrative + military + social crisis, not one variable.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Deccan war and jagirdari crisis interacted with succession, ecology and regional resistance but do not alone explain decline.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 23 final answer spine

START -> ecology and Shahji service world; no geography/nationalist determinism

TRACE -> forts/Javli -> Purandar/Agra -> coronation -> institutions

EXPLAIN -> revenue + chauth/sardeshmukhi + army + littoral navy

SUCCESSORS -> Sambhaji -> Rajaram/Gingee -> Tarabai

IMPERIAL -> 1686/87 annexation -> logistics loop -> jagir feedback

PYQ -> zero direct Topic-23 routes, 2018-2026; Mains has no key

BOUND -> Topic 22 religion/Rajputs | Topic 25 full decline

VERDICT -> regional state resilience exposed Mughal overextension.